

2024-2025 School Survey Results

Safe Routes to School Presentation
April 11th, 2025

SafeRoutes



**Larchmont Mamaroneck
Bike Lane Project**
Safe Streets for Our Kids



Goals of this survey

Understand existing conditions of different Mamaroneck schools to:

- Direct safety efforts appropriately
- Measure progress
- Solicit community feedback



Participation

- Survey response rate was up significantly thanks to a big push from the PTA and the administration
- There is still room for improvement, 30%+ would be ideal

	Responses	Enrollment	Rate	Prior
Chatsworth	168	652	26%	10%
Central	166	498	33%	- %
Murray	76	683	11%	11%
Mamaroneck Ave	123	631	19%	6%
Hommocks	319	1,281	25%	4%
MHS	172	1,779	10%	7%
Total	1,024	5,524	19%	7%

Source: Projected enrollment from the 2024-2025 Mamaroneck School Budget

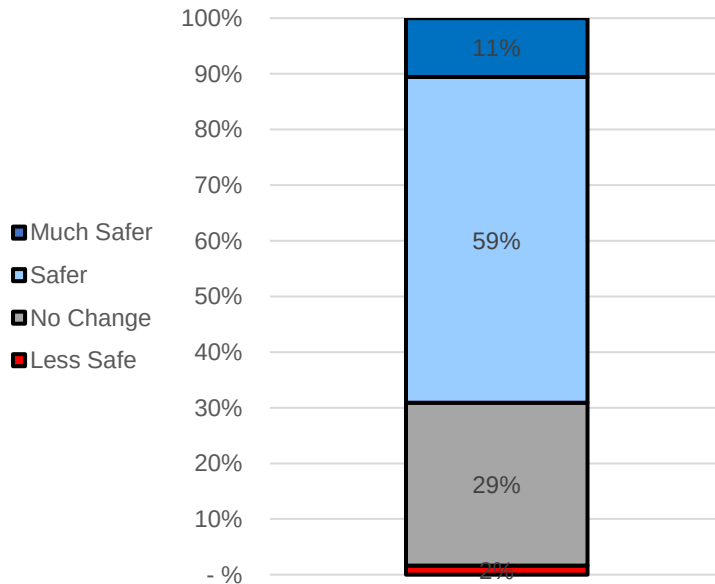


Mamaroneck Avenue Improvements

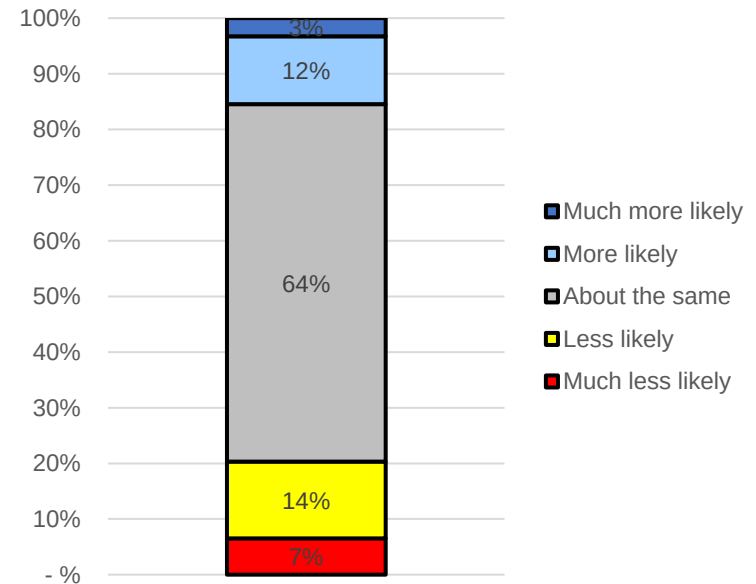
Reception of Mamaroneck Avenue Changes

- 70% of respondents said they felt safer, with a small group saying much safer
- Yet roughly the same size group said it didn't make it more likely for their children to walk or bike

Have the changes made on Mamaroneck Avenue over the summer made you feel?



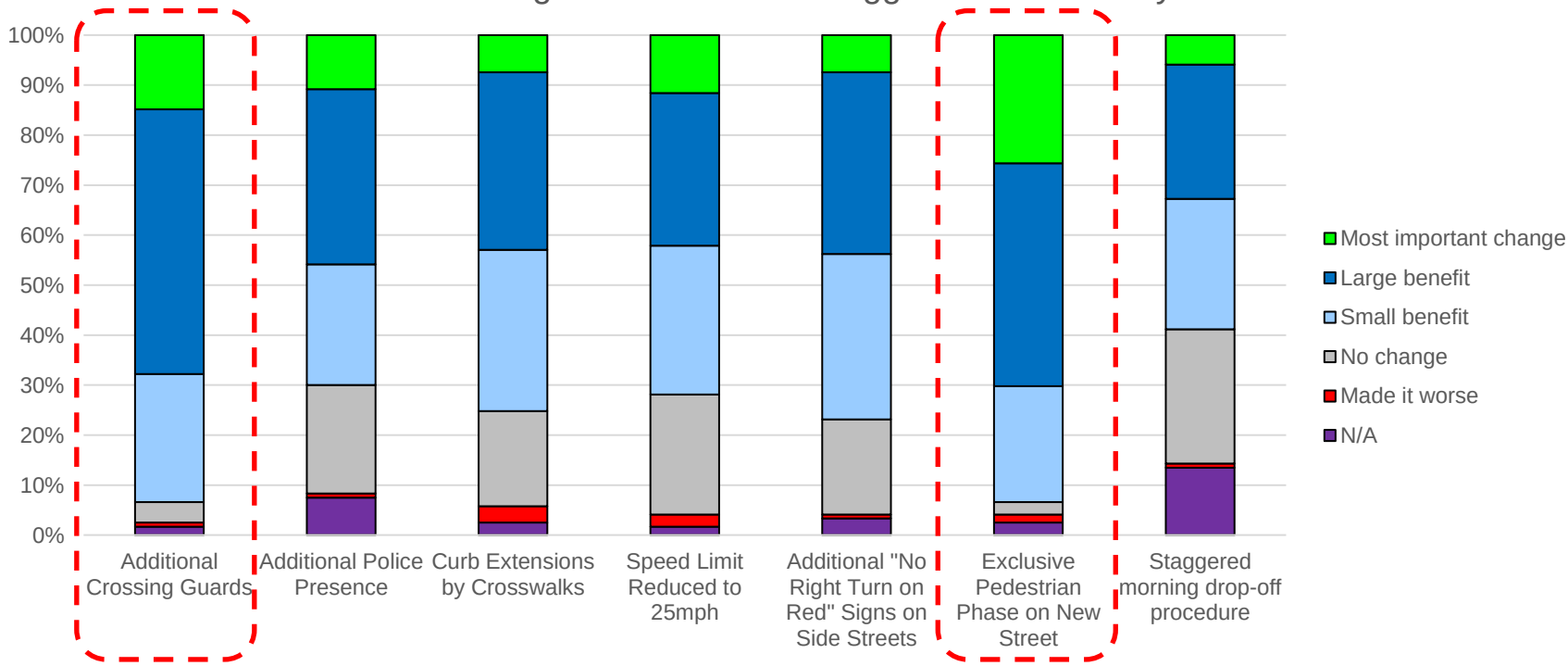
Is your child more likely to walk or bike to school because of these changes?



Reception of individual changes

- Additional crossing guards and the Exclusive Pedestrian Phase (4-way walk signal) were the most important changes
- All the other changes were well received

Which changes have made the biggest difference to you?



Comments on changes

- There were 56 comments. Overall people saw positive impact of changes but think more needs to be done
- Positive Changes Acknowledged: Some commenters noted positive impacts from the changes made so far, particularly the addition of crossing guards.
 - “The changes along Mamaroneck Avenue are amazing.”
 - “Great job to the parents that got it done!”
 - “Changes so far have been positive.”
 - “Consistent crossing guards at additional intersections has been the most helpful”
 - “The crossing guards have made the most impact...”
- More Crossing Guards were requested:
 - Near the southbound I-95 exit ramp onto Mamaroneck Ave
 - At Mamaroneck Ave and Halstead Ave (under the RR tracks)
 - At Ralph Ave and Elliot Ave

Comments on changes (cont'd)

- Speeding and Red Light Running: Many commenters observe persistent speeding and red light violations, despite changes.
 - “Cars drive through red lights on a daily basis, and they block the box at the intersections.”
 - “I continue to see cars speed and run red lights on Mamaroneck Ave near MAS.”
 - “...the cars continue to speed and go through the red light at that intersection almost every day, no exaggerating.”
 - “The reduction in speed has not benefited as you have a lot of traffic coming off the 95 that does not obey the reduction in speed near MAS.”
- Pedestrian Safety Concerns: Despite improvements like crossing guards, many still feel unsafe walking, especially children. Specific intersections and lack of pedestrian-focused signals are highlighted.
 - “All crosswalks on Mamaroneck Ave should have dedicated pedestrian walking times.”
 - “I wish Mamaroneck would have more ‘pedestrian exclusive phases’ like Larchmont does.”
 - “There should be a pedestrian exclusive phase at all lights on Mamaroneck Ave”
 - “One terrible area still remains: the intersection of Mamaroneck Ave at Hoyt (where there is no walk/don’t walk sign) and Halstead (under the RR tracks - where there is no crossing guard or pedestrian exclusive phase).”

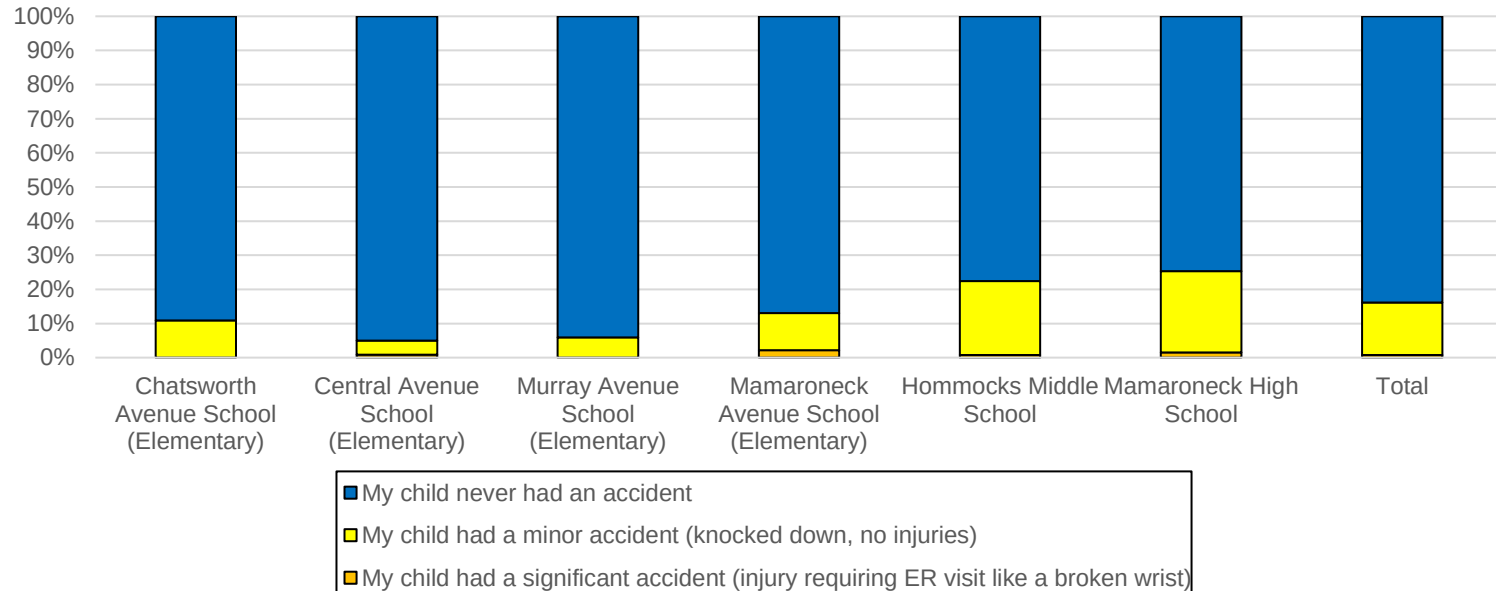


General Survey

Accidents

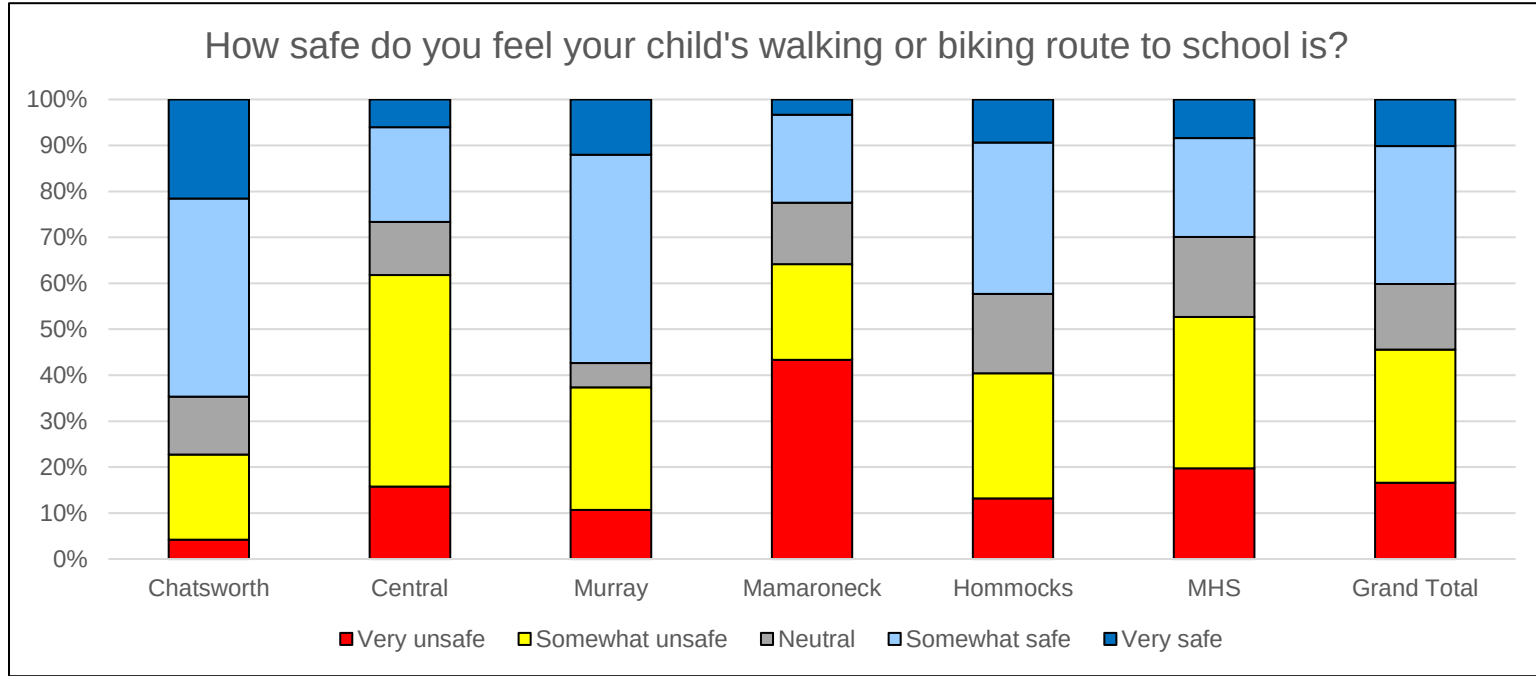
- About 16% of parents reported their child had some sort of accident
- But by the time a child is in high school that is ~25%
- The vast majority of accidents were minor
- There were 6 accidents requiring an ER visit

Has your child ever been in an accident walking or biking to school?



Parent Safety Perception

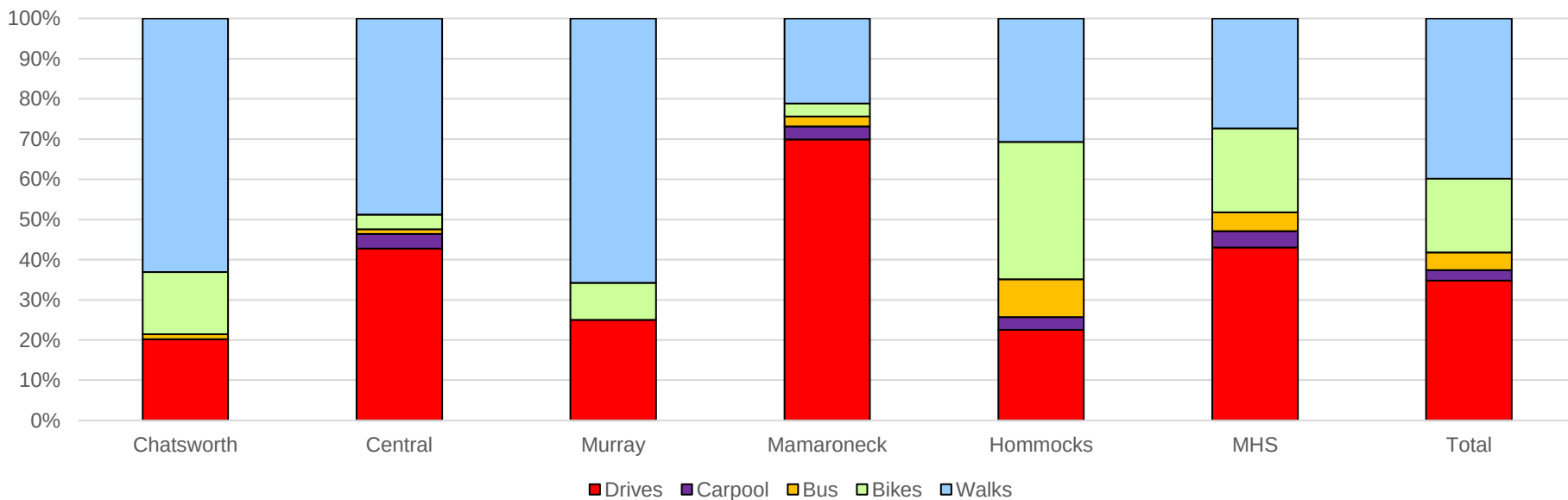
- Safety perception varied widely between schools
- Chatsworth and Murray Avenue stood out as being perceived as safe
- Mamaroneck Ave stood out as very unsafe (though not worse than 2023 despite the fatal crash)
- This is largely consistent from the 2022-2023 survey



Transport Method

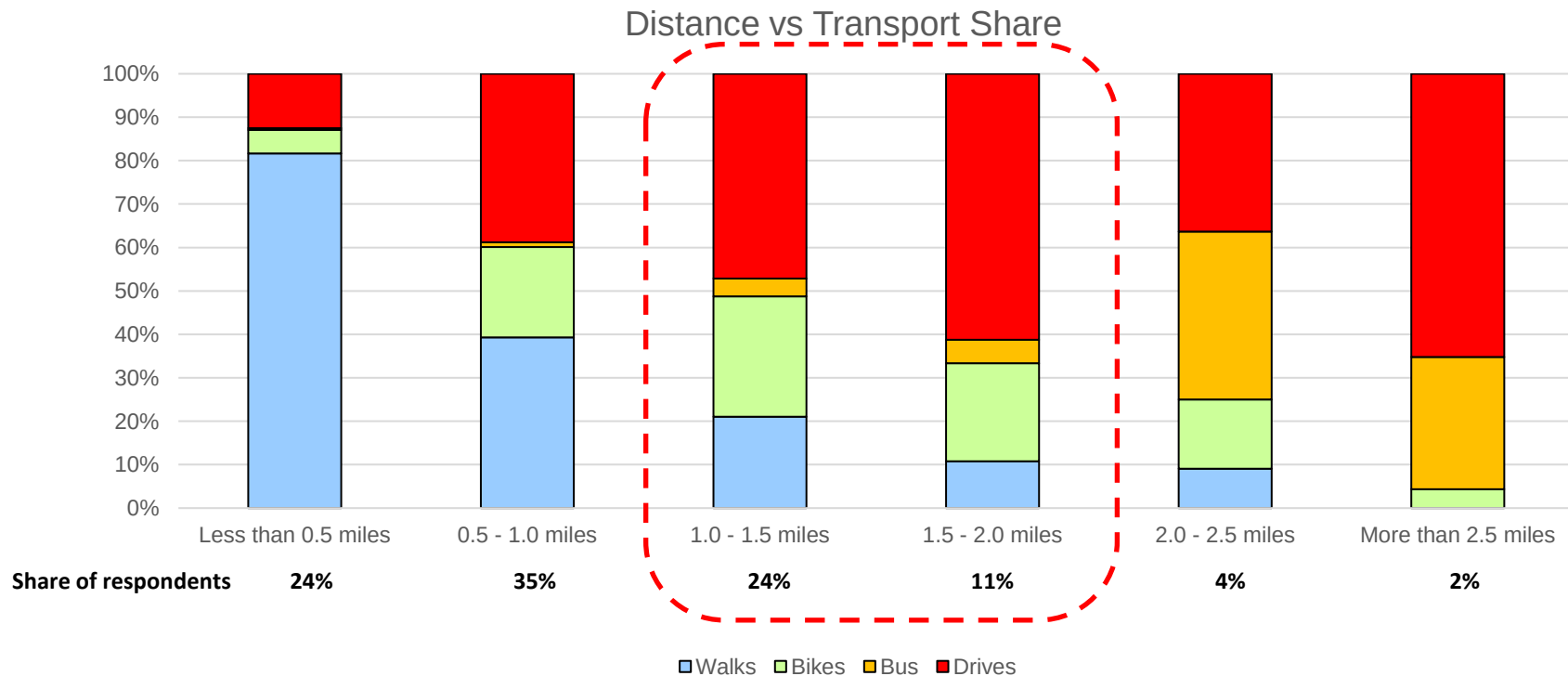
- Children's transportation choice varies dramatically by school
- Mamaroneck Avenue stands out with very high driving share
- Hommocks has the highest biking share
- MHS also has high driving share; approximately 20% of that is students driving themselves

2024-2025 - What is the primary way your child gets to school?



Distance vs transport share

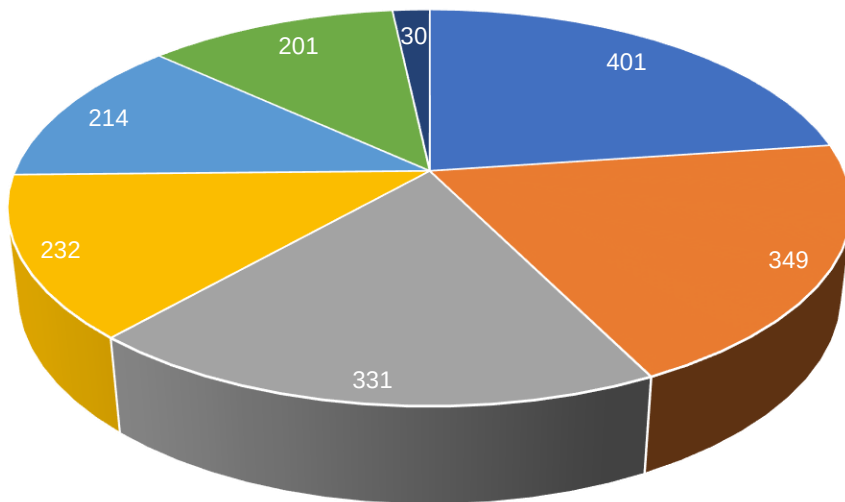
- Walking and driving are very correlated to distance to school
- 94% of respondents are 2 miles or less from their schools
- Biking is not particularly correlated, but its maximum share is 1-2 miles
- 1-2 miles is the sweet spot for biking and the key area of focus



Why Walk or Bike?

- Reasons for walking or biking varied
- Convenience (easier than driving) as the most cited factor
- Economic benefit (savings on car) was not a big factor

What are the main reasons your children don't walk or bike to school?

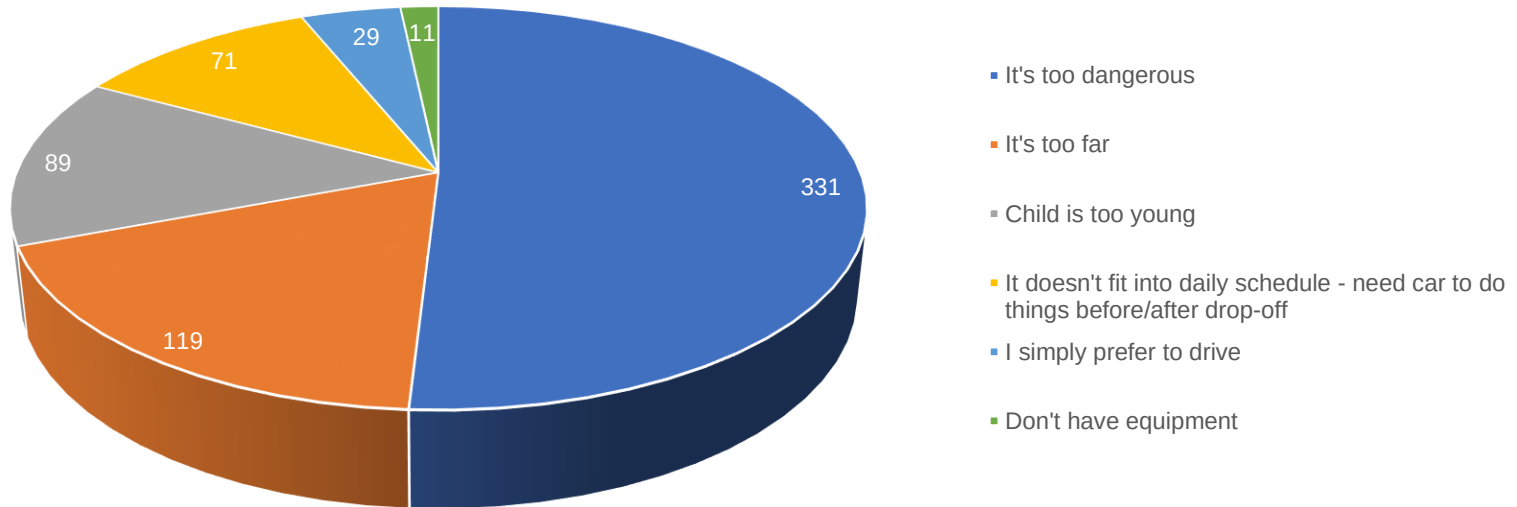


- Convenience - easier than driving
- My child prefers/enjoys walking or biking
- Health benefits
- Environmental benefits
- Community benefits
- Schedule - cannot drive children due to scheduling conflict
- Economic - don't have a car available

Why Not?

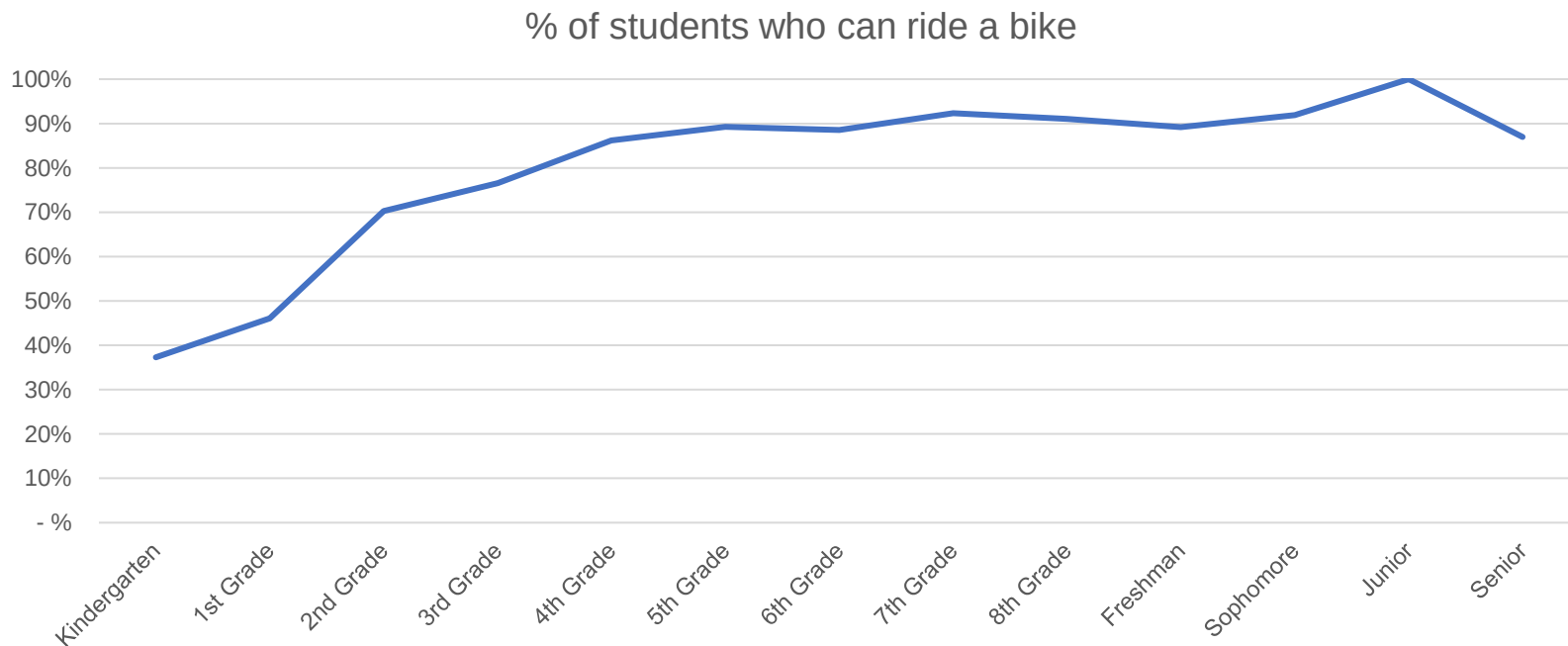
- The reason for not walking or biking is more focused – the most cited response was the danger
- Lack of equipment was not a factor

What are the main reasons your children don't walk or bike to school?



Bike Riding Ability

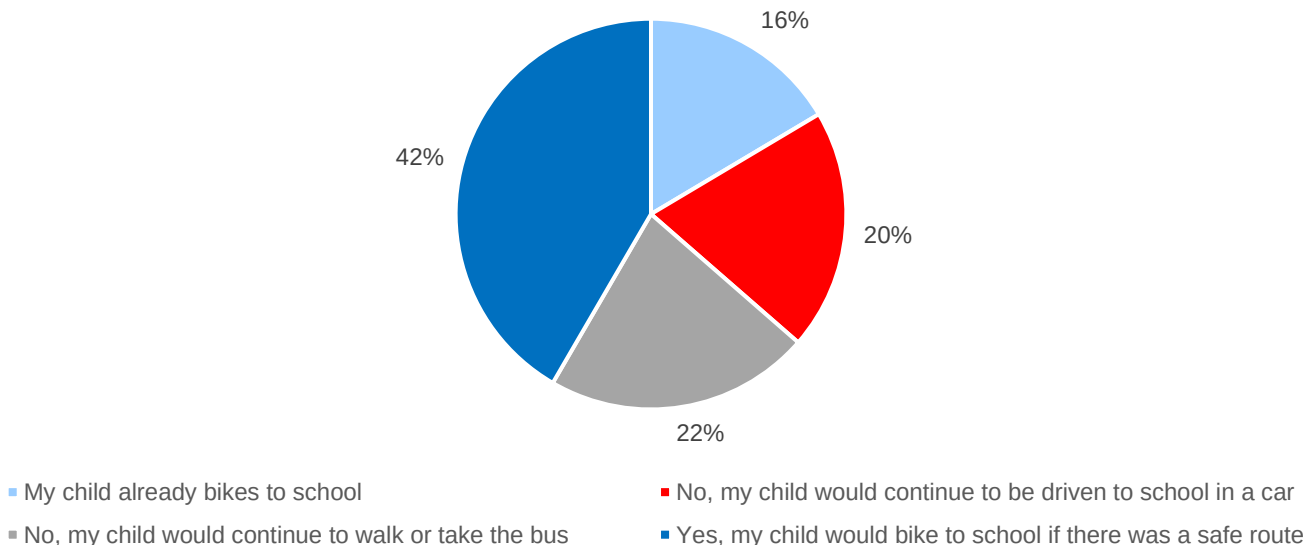
- By 4th grade, 85%+ of students say they can ride a bike
- Exact language was “Does your child know how to ride a bike well enough to get to school and have a bike?” which is a higher level than just riding in the driveway
- <5% of students say they can ride a bike but do not have one



Boston Post Road Bike Lane

- George Latimer (former County Executive, now Congressional Rep) wanted us to verify that improved bike infrastructure would lead to more biking
- 42% of parents said it would make it more likely and 16% already bike

Would a safe bike path on Boston Post Road increase your child's likelihood of biking to school?



Comments

There were 529 total comments covering a wide variety of topics. Here are the key themes:

- Need for Safer Biking Infrastructure (107 comments): Many comments expressed a strong desire for dedicated and protected bike lanes, particularly on major routes like Boston Post Road (BPR), Weaver Street, and Palmer Avenue, to make biking to school safer. Some suggested physical barriers for added protection.
 - “Bike lanes for kids to get to school would be AMAZING”
 - “It makes me uneasy to have my son bike to school because there is no bike lane. To walk takes 30 minutes each way.”
 - “I wish there were a better bike path through Flint Park”
 - “It’s difficult to drive without bike paths because the kids can be all over the place. Bike paths make things safer for all”

Comments (continued)

- Sidewalks & Crosswalks (75 comments): Respondents frequently cited the lack of sidewalks, poor sidewalk conditions (narrow, uneven, blocked), and the need for more numerous and safer crosswalks as major issues.

Improvements to specific intersections were also frequently requested.

- “Lack of sidewalks on busy roads is my biggest concern. (Rockland, Fenimore, Forest)”
- “More sidewalks are needed for safety.”
- “Repair of sidewalks is necessary!!”
- “Weaver to Hommocks - I think the sidewalk should be widened as I sometimes see kids step onto the street from the sidewalk.”

Comments (continued)

- ***NEW*** Driver Behavior & Enforcement (164 comments): Widespread concern exists about dangerous driving behaviors like speeding, distracted/aggressive driving, failure to yield, running red lights/stop signs, and illegal U-turns or double parking. This led to calls for increased police presence, traffic enforcement (ticketing, speed cameras), and traffic calming measures (speed bumps, signs, lights).
- **This is new and didn't appear in the prior survey**
 - "Drivers don't respect the right of way of pedestrians. Drivers must be penalized for infractions and incentivized to leave their car at home"
 - "I am shocked by how many drivers go through the red lights on Boston Post road"
 - "Post and Palmer are overcrowded and drivers are way too aggressive in general... there does not appear to be any consequences for aggressive and dangerous driving..."

Comments (continued)

- Need for More/Better Busing (38 Comments): A common theme was the call for expanded school bus services, potentially including paid options, to alleviate traffic, enhance safety, and provide transportation for students living further from schools or without safe routes. Issues with the reliability of current public bus services were also noted.
 - “We do need to re-evaluate the availability of buses with safety in mind and not just distance”
 - “I am writing to request that the school district & DOT consider adding additional stops to the bee bus line, particularly in the Mamaroneck Harbor areas”
 - “My daughter last year took the Beeline Bus but this year it gets to school too late. It arrives with only 2 minutes until class starts so she is refusing to take the bus.”

Comments (continued)

- A number of specific locations came up frequently:
 - Roads frequently mentioned
 - Boston Post Road – 111
 - Weaver – 107
 - Palmer – 52
 - Rockland – 30
 - Fenimore – 22
 - Mamaroneck Ave - 18
 - Intersections frequently mentioned
 - Weaver Street and Palmer Ave – 19
 - Trader Joes on BPR – 14
 - 95 Off-Ramp on Mamaroneck Ave – 7
 - Howell and Weaver – 7
 - Beach and Boston Post Road - 7

Individual School Comments

- There were many specific comments (too many to go through as a group), but we will send them to each school's Safe Routes rep to go through and figure out if there are actionable items.
- Example:
 - "Further a private business (the tire place on BPR right by the police station, is permitted to park on the sidewalk so pedestrians have to step into the busy street, and without visibility"